



I'm a 16 year old person living in Denmark. I'm born in Denmark, but my parents are from Iceland. I just finished primary school in Denmark and am now considering what my next step should be. I'm fluent in danish.

What educational path would you recommend for me?

Thanks for sharing a bit about your background! Since you're 16, fluent in Danish, and have just completed primary school (folkeskolen), you're at the typical point to choose a secondary education path in Denmark. The best choice depends on your interests, goals, and how you like to learn.

Here's a breakdown of the main options in Denmark and how to choose the best path:

## **General Upper Secondary Education (Gymnasiale Uddannelser)**

These prepare you for higher education (university or university college):

### 1. **STX (Studentereksamen) – General Upper Secondary School**

- Broad academic program: languages, science, humanities, and social sciences.
- Good if you enjoy academic learning and are considering university.
- Takes 3 years.

### 2. **HHX – Higher Commercial Examination**

- Focus on business, economics, marketing, and international topics.
- Great if you're interested in entrepreneurship, business, or economics.
- Also 3 years and leads to university.

### 3. **HTX – Higher Technical Examination**

- Focus on science, technology, and IT.
- Best if you like engineering, natural sciences, or technical fields.
- 3 years and prepares for technical or science degrees.

### 4. **HF – Higher Preparatory Examination**

- Shorter (2 years), more practical/thematic.
- Often chosen by students who want a slightly more flexible or adult-oriented study.
- Good if you're not sure yet, or want quicker access to higher education or professions.

## **Vocational Education and Training (Erhvervsuddannelse – EUD)**

If you prefer hands-on work and want to start a career more quickly, this might be right for you:

- Combines school and apprenticeship (praktik).
- Over 100 tracks: electrician, carpenter, chef, mechanic, hairdresser, IT supporter, and many more.

- Can take 3–5 years, depending on the program.
- Some vocational tracks also allow you to access higher education later via EUX.

## **EUX – Vocational + Academic Hybrid**

- Combines vocational training with subjects from gymnasium.
- You graduate with both a trade qualification *and* access to university.
- Great if you want the option to both work and study further.

## **Extra Consideration: Icelandic Heritage**

Since your parents are from Iceland:

- You might consider **learning or strengthening your Icelandic**, if you haven't already.
- Some Danish-Icelandic students explore options in both countries (study or work).
- Being bilingual/multicultural can be a big advantage for future opportunities in the Nordics or Europe.

## **What to Think About**

Ask yourself:

- Do I enjoy academic subjects or practical work more?
- Am I curious about going to university, or do I want to work sooner?
- Are there specific fields (science, arts, IT, business, etc.) I'm passionate about?
- Do I want to work in Denmark, Iceland, or internationally in the future?

## **My Recommendation (based on what you've shared)**

If you're not sure yet, but are open to university later and enjoy a broad education:

 **STX** is a safe and flexible choice.

If you're more hands-on, want to enter the workforce earlier, or like technical skills:

 Consider **EUX** – it gives you a strong mix of career and study options.

Would you like help deciding based on your interests? I can help you narrow it down if you tell me what subjects or future jobs you're interested in!